Mnemos Roadmap to Public Release

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Summary

The team recommends four more builds before a public v1.0: harden for release first, then deepen the learning, then polish the world, then run a closed beta of at least 20 adults for 4 weeks. The independent auditor rates v0.3 at 7/10 provisionally and lists 8 must-fix items for release, none of them large.

- **v0.4 Release hardening:** fix the 8 auditor must-fixes plus accessibility blockers.
- **v0.5 Learning depth:** harder, more realistic face drills, review built into relics and the Crypt, and a coached first day.
- **v0.6 World and story:** gate restoration animations, chapter cutscenes, Crypt boss floors and weekly challenges.
- **v0.7 Closed beta:** real players tune the difficulty, the session length and the Crypt curve.
- **v1.0 Public release:** GitHub Pages, trademark cleared, licences shipped.

One earlier blocker is already fixed. All five agents flagged that the shared pixel engine could not be imported; it was split into plain and React parts during v0.3 integration.

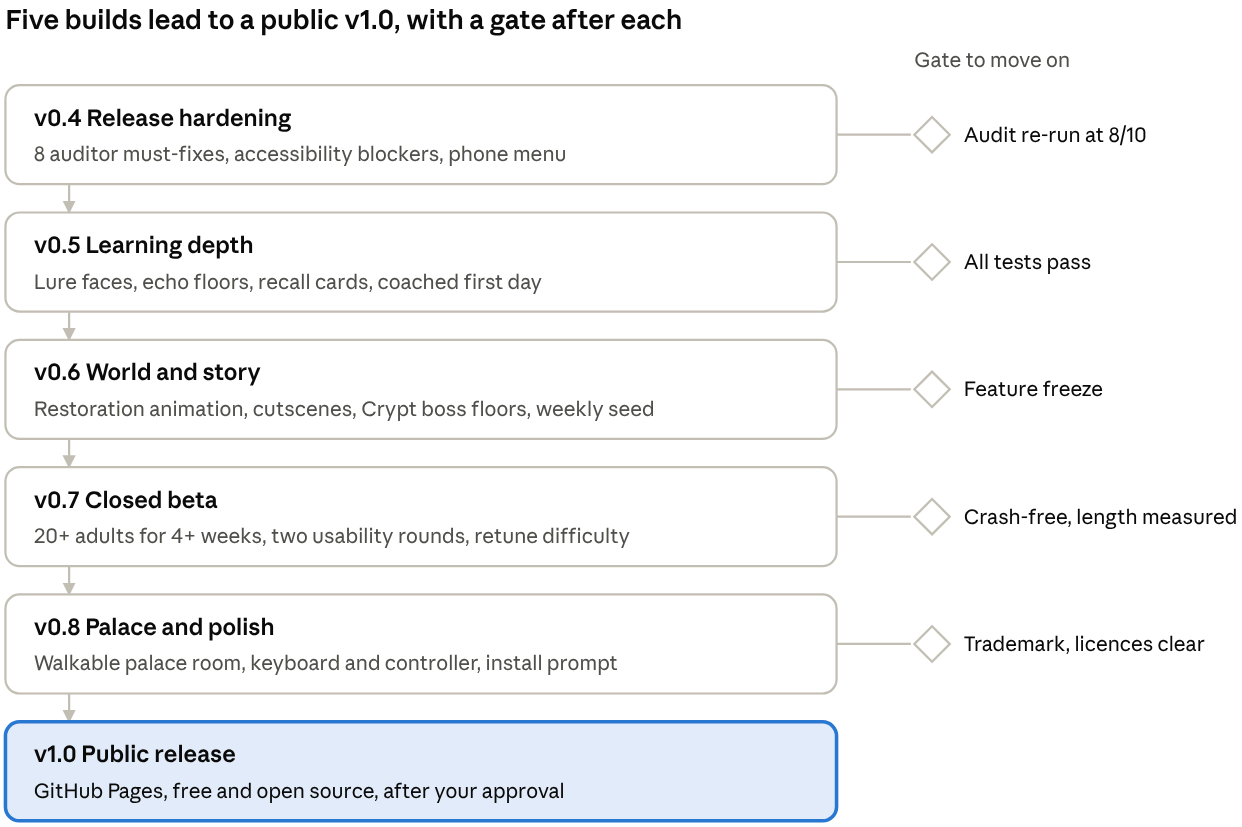
What each agent recommended

Each specialist was asked for its top improvements, UI changes and release risks. Their strongest single idea is listed first.

Agent	Top recommendation	Other priorities	Biggest release risk
Faces and portraits	Lure faces that differ in only 1 or 2 features, so players practise fine detail (M)	Same person with a changed look; show the face's key features after each answer; fix contrast on very dark skin tones	Representation review of 500 sample faces; a text-hint mode for low vision

Agent	Top recommendation	Other priorities	Biggest release risk
Relics and collectibles	Recall cards: answer a question about an item to polish it, turning the collection into review (M)	Fading relics when a probe slips; Calder's Ledger as a book; group unlock moments into one screen	Item ids must never change; mid-year months have too few rewards
The Undercroft (Crypt)	Echo floors that re-ask items from two floors up, giving spaced recall inside a run (S)	Boss floor every 10th; a weekly fixed seed; optional modifiers	Difficulty untested; timed floors ignore the extended-timer setting; closing mid-floor gives a free retry
World and scenes	Restoration animation when a gate is passed: fog rolls back, lamps light (S)	Walkable palace room; chapter cutscene panels; day and night; layered depth effect	Battery on low-end Android; bundle size about 880 KB; map needs text labels
Game UI	Phone navigation: 5 slots with a Menu, since 6 tabs are cramped (S)	Coached first day with tips; regrouped settings with text size; keyboard and controller play; install prompt	Focus hidden behind sticky bars; canvas screens need text equivalents; colour-only cues
Independent auditor	8 must-fixes before v1.0 (Section 6)	Migration tests, changelog, issue template, privacy statement	Old builds stuck in the offline cache; sound on by default; font licence text missing

Roadmap



roadmap · 6 releases, 5 gates

Each build must pass its gate before the next starts. The beta in v0.7 is the slowest step, because it needs at least 4 weeks of real use.

Feature backlog by phase

Effort: S is under a day of build work, M is 1 to 3 days, L is a week or more. The beta and its usability testing set the real calendar more than build effort does.

Phase	Item	Area	Effort	Why
v0.4	Version the offline cache per release and show "update available"	Operations	S	Players can get stuck on an old build

Phase	Item	Area	Effort	Why
v0.4	Sound off by default, separate mute for dialogue blips	Accessibility	S	Auditor must-fix
v0.4	Ship the font licence text and a third-party licence list	Legal	S	Required by the font licence
v0.4	Validate all new save data (Crypt, relics, quests), cap import size, test 50 corrupted files	Security	M	Untrusted files must never break the app
v0.4	Crypt respects the extended-timer setting; leaving mid-floor costs a flask	Crypt	S	Accessibility and fairness
v0.4	Backup reminder after 7 days, Safari data-loss warning, storage status	Data	S	iPhone Safari can delete data after about 7 days unused
v0.4	Focus never hidden behind bars; 200% text with nothing clipped; shapes as well as colour	Accessibility	M	WCAG 2.2 AA blockers
v0.4	Text equivalents for map, Crypt and portraits	Accessibility	M	Screen-reader users
v0.4	Test that fails if any item id changes	Relics	S	Renaming an id erases ownership
v0.4	Phone navigation: Today, Veyra, Crypt, Progress, Menu	UI	S	Six tabs are cramped at 390 px
v0.4	Session-length copy: "about 20 to 30 minutes" until measured	Honesty	S	Auditor must-fix

Phase	Item	Area	Effort	Why
v0.5	Lure faces and "same person, different look" drills	Faces	M	Trains the detail real name recall needs
v0.5	Show each face's key features after answering	Faces	S	Teaches what to notice
v0.5	Echo floors in the Crypt	Crypt	S	Spaced recall inside a run
v0.5	Recall cards and fading relics	Relics	M	Collection becomes review, not grind
v0.5	Coached day 1 with Wren, first-time tips, replay tips	UI	M	New players understand Lumen, keys, relics
v0.5	Settings regrouped, text size 100 to 150%, volume controls	UI	M	Comfort and accessibility
v0.5	Larger word and name pools	Content	M	Deep Crypt runs repeat items
v0.6	Gate restoration animation on the map	World	S	The payoff moment for a month's work
v0.6	Chapter cutscene panels with Wren and the player	Story	M	Story told visually, not only in text
v0.6	Portrait moods match each dialogue line	Story	S	Characters feel alive
v0.6	Calder's Ledger as a book; grouped unlock screen after gates	Relics	S	Stronger reward moments
v0.6	Crypt boss floor every 10th, weekly seed, modifiers	Crypt	M	Reasons to return and push limits
v0.6	Day, night and weather palettes; layered depth effect	World	M	Atmosphere and the requested 3D feel, without heavy 3D
v0.6	Mid-year rewards to fill the sparse months	Relics	S	Balance

Phase	Item	Area	Effort	Why
v0.7	Closed beta: 20+ adults, 4 weeks minimum	Testing	L	Tunes difficulty and length with real data
v0.7	Two usability rounds of 6 to 8 people plus accessibility testers	Testing	M	Finds confusing game terms
v0.7	Local stats on where Crypt runs end; retune the curve	Crypt	S	Target runs ending around floors 8 to 12
v0.8	Walkable palace room: walk between stops, items appear as props	World	L	Strongest learning hook of all proposals
v0.8	Keyboard and controller play; install prompt after day 3	UI	M	Desktop and installed-app players
v0.8	Three-quarter view faces	Faces	L	Recognising a face from a new angle
Later	Shareable run card image; opt-in leaderboard (needs a server)	Crypt	S / L	Leaderboard breaks the offline design, so last
Later	Translations; optional anonymous research export	Platform	L	Wider reach and evidence

UI and UX changes

The interface already reads as a game; the next changes are about navigation on phones, teaching new players, and making every screen usable without sight of a canvas.

Change	What it looks like	Phase
Five-slot phone menu	Today, Veyra, Crypt, Progress, Menu (Relics, Palaces, Keeper inside Menu); desktop keeps the side list	v0.4

Change	What it looks like	Phase
Map as the home view (option)	Tap a district to open a sheet with its banner, quest and Begin	v0.6
Coached first day	Wren walks the player through day 1; tips appear the first time Lumen, keys and relics show up; tips can be skipped and replayed	v0.5
Settings in four groups	Audio, Display (theme, readable text, text size, motion), Training (timers), Data	v0.5
One unlock moment per session	A single grouped reward screen; a gate pass shows Calder's page first, then the artifact	v0.6
Reliquary helpers	"Recently earned" row; hints that point to a skill, never to grinding	v0.5
Crypt feedback	Coaching after a failed floor based on the error type; a small floor map of the run; "Resume descent" on Today	v0.5
Crisp pixel scaling	Scenes snap to whole multiples (2x, 3x) so pixels stay even	v0.4
Empty states	Relics, Crypt, Palaces and Progress explain what is coming and when	v0.4
Keyboard and controller	Arrow keys through menus, number keys for tabs, Esc to leave, gamepad support	v0.8
Install flow	Offer "install as app" after day 3, with iPhone instructions; storage made persistent	v0.8

The study and recall screens stay still and quiet in every phase. That rule protects the learning and is not up for trade.

Public release requirements

A public v1.0 needs everything under **Must**. Most of it is small; the two long poles are the 4-week closed beta and the trademark search on the name.

Must

- [ ] **Honest claims:** every claim says "performance on Mnemos tasks"; no promise of better memory or IQ; techniques cited, outcomes not.
- [ ] **Session length:** copy says "about 20 to 30 minutes" until the beta measures the real median.
- [ ] **Scores:** Training Score marked provisional for 14 days; "not an IQ or clinical test" on onboarding, Progress and the README; no game reward can raise a learning score.
- [ ] **Data safety:** "stored only in this browser" shown clearly; backup reminder after 7 days; Safari data-loss warning; export and import include Crypt, relics and quest state.
- [ ] **Import security:** full validation of every field, a 5 MB cap, no imported text ever shown as HTML, 50 corrupted files tested.
- [ ] **Legal:** trademark search for "Mnemos" in the US, EU and Canada (software and education classes); font licence text shipped; third-party licence list; content attribution list for facts and vocabulary.
- [ ] **Accessibility:** WCAG 2.2 AA checked with NVDA and VoiceOver; sound off by default; no motion during study or recall; text at 200% with nothing lost.
- [ ] **Devices:** Chrome, Firefox, Safari and Edge on desktop; Safari on iPhone; Chrome on Android, including one low-end Android phone.
- [ ] **Closed beta:** 20 or more adults for at least 4 weeks, long enough to reach the first monthly challenge and the 7-day recalls; track completion and bugs.
- [ ] **Updates:** offline cache versioned per release with an "update available" prompt.

Should

- [ ] Test that loads every older save format through migration.
- [ ] Version numbers and a changelog for every release.
- [ ] GitHub issue template and an in-app "report a problem" that exports a cleaned copy of state.
- [ ] Privacy statement, plus an automated check that the app makes no network calls.
- [ ] Performance budget: page load and frame time measured on a low-end phone.
- [ ] Representation review of a 500-face sample by a few outside reviewers.

Could

- [ ] Optional, anonymous, opt-in research export.
- [ ] Translations.

- [ ] A small pilot study comparing players with their own day-1 baseline.

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Open decisions for you

#	Decision	Recommendation
1	Keep the name "Mnemos" if the trademark search finds conflicts?	Search first; keep "Keepers of Veyra" as a fallback title
2	Sound on or off by default	Off by default, with a clear sound button (auditor)
3	Leaderboards (needs a server, breaks offline-only)	Not for v1.0; ship a shareable run card instead
4	Walkable palace room (largest build item)	Build after the beta, in v0.8
5	Map as the home screen	Offer it as an option first, decide from beta feedback
6	Three story choices made during the relics build: the Gallery key and the Warden ring are artifacts rather than side-quest rewards, and page 12 quotes Calder's final lesson	Approve as written, or say which to change
7	Who runs the beta and how testers are found	You recruit 20+ adults; the team prepares the beta build, feedback form and tracking
8	GitHub account and repository name for publishing	Needed before v1.0